

Realigning climate-forcing players? Power Resources Mobilisation pathways in the Just Transition

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Research Questions

- How do just transition policies impact support for decarbonization policies among workers in vulnerable industries and sectors?
- How do trade and labour unions impact the political realignment of workers towards decarbonization policy support?

Hypotheses

- **Hyp 1:** When climate policies are coupled with Just Transition measures, support among exposed workers increases
- **Hyp 2:** Endorsement of just transition policies by trade unions increases support for climate policy among workers in carbon-intensive sectors.

Empirical strategy

- Factorial vignette experiment AND conjoint experiment embedded in an online survey
- Snowballing procedure: survey shared by unions and employer organization
- **Should we include online targetting through facebook adds?**
- 1500 workers in France and Germany, maybe beyond

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Vignette Experiment – Prompt

Prompt

To address global warming, the government has adopted a five-year plan to reduce emissions in high-polluting sectors by phasing out fossil fuels. As part of this effort, your region (long reliant on coal and heavy industry) has been selected for early implementation of this plan. Your company, a large employer in the area, expects to reduce its workforce by 30% over the coming years. To limit the social costs of this transition, the government considers introducing a Just Transition package. **FACTOR 1 FACTOR 2**

Vignette Experiment – Factors

Experimental Factors

- **Factor 1: Policy Design**

- **A. Workers-oriented support:** While the plan is still under development, it is expected to include some form of direct financial compensation and job guarantees for affected workers.
- **B. Community-oriented support:** While the plan is still under development, it is expected to include some form of public investment in local infrastructure, schools, and healthcare services.

- **Factor 2: Union Support**

- **A. Union opposition:** The trade union representing workers in your industry has opposed the Just Transition package.
- **B. Union support:** The trade union representing workers in your industry has endorsed the Just Transition package.

Vignette Experiment - Main Outcomes

- To what extent do you oppose or **support such a policy**? 1 = Strongly oppose, 7 = Strongly support
- Impact on unions support - How much do you support or oppose **unions' actions**? 1 = Strongly oppose, 7 = Strongly support
- Impact on government support - How much do you support or oppose **government's actions**? 1 = Strongly oppose, 7 = Strongly support

Vignette Experiment - Mechanisms

- How **fair** or **unfair** do you think the just-transition package is? 1 = Very unfair, 7 = Very fair
- How **legitime** or **illegitime** do you think the just-transition package is? 1 = Strongly illegitime 7 = Strongly legitime
- How **likely** or **unlikely** the policy will be implemented? 1 = Very unlikely 7 = Very likely
- How likely or unlikely workers will receive **compensations** for the loss of their activities? 1 = Very unlikely 7 = Very likely
- How **effective** or ineffective the policy is to reduce greenhouse gas emissions? 1 = Very ineffective 7 = Very effective

Conjoint Experiment – Prompt

Prompt

To address global warming, the government has adopted a five-year plan to reduce emissions in high-polluting sectors by phasing out fossil fuels. As part of this national effort, your region has been selected for early implementation of this plan. Your company is directly affected and expects to reduce its workforce by 30% over the next five years.

To limit the social costs of this transition, the government considers introducing a **Just Transition package** for affected workers and communities. In the following task, you will be shown four pairs of proposed Just Transition packages. Each proposal includes a combination of features such as financial support, job retraining, community investment, and more.

For each pair, please review the proposals carefully and select the one you find more acceptable. There are no right or wrong answers — we are interested in your preferences.

Conjoint Experiment – Attributes

Key Policy Features

Respondents evaluate policy packages defined by six attributes:

1. **Financial compensation:** a) None, b) lump sum, or c) monthly income bridge.
2. **Job support:** a) None, b) personalized job support, or c) job transition guarantee.
3. **(Re-)training:** a) None, b) basic (entry-level), or c) advanced training.
4. **Location of new activity:** a) Local (under 30 min commute), b) neighbouring area (1–2 hours), or c) other region (relocation).
5. **Community investment:** a) None, b) green job-creating investment, c) local infrastructure upgrading, or d) welfare services investment.
6. **Union position:** a) No position, b) union opposes, or c) union supports.

Conjoint Experiment – Outcomes

- 4 pairs of hypothetical policy packages are assessed
- **Main outcome:** a dummy indicating the preferred policy
- **Secondary outcome:** how strongly do you feel about your choice from 1 to 3

Thank You!